

# Duck OS Emergency Checklist

## 5 Actions to Stop a Burnout Spiral

By **Adduckivity** | [duckos.adduckivity.com](https://duckos.adduckivity.com)

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*"Protect the System. If the system breaks, everything breaks." — Law 3, Duck OS*

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## You Know This Feeling

Chaotic inside. Empty inside. Both at the same time.

That's not weakness. That's your System Alert firing. This checklist exists for that exact moment.

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## The 5 Actions

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### 01 — Name the Signal

When you feel **chaotic but empty** — stop. Don't push through. Don't open another tab.

Say it out loud or write it down:

*"My system is about to break."*

That's it. Naming it is the first circuit breaker.

**Why it works:** ADHD + MDD creates noise without direction. Naming the state separates you from it — and activates your prefrontal cortex instead of running on autopilot.

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## 02 — Isolate Intentionally

You want to be alone. Do it — but with a rule.

**Set a timer: 30 minutes.**

- Close all notifications
- Lie down or sit in silence
- Do nothing

This is not giving up. This is **System Maintenance**.

**Why it works:** Your brain is overstimulated. Input reduction is the fastest way to lower the internal pressure. 30 minutes prevents it from becoming a full-day disappearance.

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## 03 — Activate Your Anchor

You have one song, one playlist, one sound that is *yours*.

Open it. Now. Don't wait until you feel ready.

*(For me this checklist — it's Linkin Park.)*

**Find yours and put it one tap away.**

**Why it works:** Music bypasses the thinking brain and hits the emotional brain directly. For ADHD, it's the fastest pattern interrupt available — faster than meditation, faster than breathing exercises.

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## 04 — Do One Tiny Thing

Don't try to be productive. Don't try to catch up.

Just move your hands.

- Touch typing
- Make your bed
- Wash one cup
- Reorganize one drawer

**Anything your hands can do without your brain's permission.**

**Why it works:** Action precedes motivation — not the other way around. The brain reboots through doing, not through thinking about doing. One tiny action is enough to break the paralysis loop.

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## 05 — Ask the System, Not Your Feelings

Don't ask: *"What do I feel like doing?"*

Ask: **"What is the fastest thing I can finish right now?"**

Then do it immediately. Don't plan. Don't organize. Just execute one thing.

Watch momentum return on its own.

**Why it works:** Feelings are unreliable when the system is stressed. A system question bypasses the emotional blockage and routes directly to action — which is where momentum lives.

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## The Full Flow

Feel chaotic + empty

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Name it → "System Alert"

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Isolate 30 min (timer on)

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Activate your anchor (music)

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Do one tiny thing with your hands

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Ask: "What's the fastest thing I can finish?"

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Do it → Momentum returns

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# What This Is Based On

This checklist comes from **20 years** of burnout cycles, ADHD, and MDD — and the 3 Laws that finally broke the loop:

- **Law 1: System > Emotion** — Build systems that run regardless of how you feel
  - **Law 2: Action Precedes Motivation** — Start first, feel ready later
  - **Law 3: Protect the System** — If you break, everything breaks
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## Save This. Use It.

The next time you feel the spiral starting — don't rely on memory.

Open this checklist. Follow step 1.

That's all you need to do.

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**Adduckivity — Duck OS for Neurodivergent Creators**

<https://immersive.adduckivity.com>

*If this helped you, share it with someone who needs it.*

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